

Year 2 Reading Comprehension - Australian Animals

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0 Alignment: AC9E2LY05

Learning Intention

Read an informational text and find key facts about Australian animals.

Reading Strategy

Look for key words. Key words help you find important facts in an information text.

Vocabulary Helper

habitat - a place where an animal lives

nocturnal - active at night

pouch - a skin pocket on some animals

Amazing Australian Animals

Australia is home to many animals that are not found in many other places. A kangaroo has strong back legs and a long tail. It can hop across open grasslands and use its tail to help it balance. A mother kangaroo carries her tiny joey in a pouch until it grows bigger.

Koalas live in gum trees and eat eucalyptus leaves. They sleep for many hours each day because their food gives them only a little energy. Koalas have sharp claws that help them climb tree trunks.

Some Australian animals are nocturnal. This means they are active at night. A possum may search for fruit, flowers and leaves after sunset. A wombat often rests in a burrow during the day and comes out when it is cooler.

Each animal has body parts and behaviours that help it survive in its habitat.

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Page 2 - Questions and written response

Warm Up - Circle the type of text.

Story / Information text / Poem

Build Your Skills

1. What helps a kangaroo balance?

2. Where does a mother kangaroo carry her joey?

3. Why do koalas sleep for many hours?

4. What does nocturnal mean?

5. Name one animal from the text that may be active at night.

6. What is this text mostly about?

Reading Challenge

Choose one animal from the text. Write two facts about how it survives.

I Can Checklist

- I read the text carefully.
- I found facts in the text.
- I answered in full sentences.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____

Year 2 Reading Comprehension - Australian Animals - Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

Warm Up answer: Accept the text type that matches the passage. Information texts should be identified as information texts; stories should be identified as stories.

Detailed answers

1. A kangaroo uses its long tail to help it balance.
2. A mother kangaroo carries her tiny joey in a pouch.
3. Koalas sleep for many hours because eucalyptus leaves give them only a little energy.
4. Nocturnal means active at night.
5. A possum or a wombat may be active at night.
6. The text is mostly about different Australian animals and how their body parts or behaviours help them live.

Challenge answer: Answers will vary. Look for a clear idea supported by a detail from the text.

Parent/Teacher Tip

Ask the child to point to the sentence in the passage that helped them answer. This builds evidence-based reading habits.

Extension Idea

Research another Australian animal and create a three-fact mini poster.

SEO metadata: Year 2 Reading Comprehension Australian Animals Worksheet - Free Printable

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